

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 6 Handout — Org is the tenancy. Project is the gym. Empty projects build no muscle.

1 - Azure & DevOps Foundations · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — org stack (what each layer actually controls)

Layer	Controls	Lab choice
Organization	Users, OAuth apps, agent pools, billing, Policies	Personal MSA owner only
Project	Boards/Repos/Pipelines/Test/Artifacts isolation	azure-100-labs (private)
Process	Work item types + states (Agile/Scrum/Basic/CMMI)	Agile for this series
Team	Backlog, area, iteration, board columns	Default project team is enough
Repo	Git (default) vs TFVC (do not use TFVC here)	Git, default branch main (Day 13)
Parallel jobs	Microsoft-hosted vs self-hosted job SKUs	Free Microsoft-hosted minute pool

Architecture B — permission bands (keep Collection Admins tiny)

Group	Power	Lab rule
Project Collection Administrators	All projects, org policies, user management	You only. Nobody from work
Project Administrators	One project's settings, repos, pipelines	Fine — you are the lab owner
Contributors	Work items, push (subject to policies), pipeline queue	Default if you ever add a friend
Readers	View boards/repos	Stakeholders later, not today
Build Administrators	Pipeline definitions / queues	Do not grant to random MSA guests
Stakeholder vs Basic	Stakeholder: limited Boards; Basic: Repos+Pipelines	You need Basic on the personal account

Architecture C — pitfalls that mix work and lab forever

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
Invite work AAD users	Employer shows in Org settings → Users	Remove them. Personal MSA only
Public project	Lab YAML and notes indexed	Visibility = Private
CMMI because it sounded serious	Change request types you will never use	Agile process on create — cannot casually swap
One org per day	Ten empty orgs, lost URLs	One org; many projects if needed; home = azure-100-labs
CLI pointing at work org	az devops project list shows client names	az devops configure --defaults organization=https://dev.azure.com/<personal>
Collection Admin sprawl	Guest with org-wide delete	Audit Org settings → Permissions → PCA

One-liner to remember

Your Azure DevOps org is a gym membership — empty projects do not build muscle; daily reps do.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal Microsoft account only. Invite nobody from work. Project azure-100-labs is home for Days 7–100.

- 1 <https://dev.azure.com/<your-org>> → Organization settings (bottom left) → Overview. Note org name and owner email.
- 2 Organization settings → Users. Confirm only your personal Microsoft account. Remove any work guest.
- 3 Organization settings → Permissions → Project Collection Administrators. You only.
- 4 New project → Name azure-100-labs → Private → Process Agile → Create.
- 5 Project settings → Overview → Description: Personal 100DaysOfAzureDevOps labs - views are my own.
- 6 az extension add --name azure-devops && az devops configure --defaults organization=<https://dev.azure.com/<your-org>> project=azure-100-labs
- 7 az devops project list -o table && az devops project show --project azure-100-labs -o jsonc

Pin CLI defaults to the personal org and home project

```
az extension add --name azure-devops
az devops login
az devops configure --defaults organization=https://dev.azure.com/<your-org> project=azure-100-labs
az devops project list --output table
az devops project show --project azure-100-labs --output jsonc
```

Done checklist

- Can explain organization vs project vs process template
- azure-100-labs exists, private, Agile
- No work accounts in Org settings → Users
- az devops configure defaults point at this org + project

Tomorrow — Day 7

Azure Boards deep dive